Brands don't pay for *followers.*

After 850+ creator deals on the brand side, these 5 checks decide who gets paid.



1 Audience fit

2 Content fit

3 Engagement health

SWIPE FOR ALL 5 →

WHAT I SAW ON THE BRAND SIDE

The creators who delivered were rarely the *biggest.*

Follower count is the easiest number to see, and the least useful one to pick on. They were the best **fit**.

EXAMPLE A

120K followers

Audience mostly outside the brand's market

WRONG FIT

EXAMPLE B

18K followers

Same country, age and interests as the brief

GETS THE DEAL

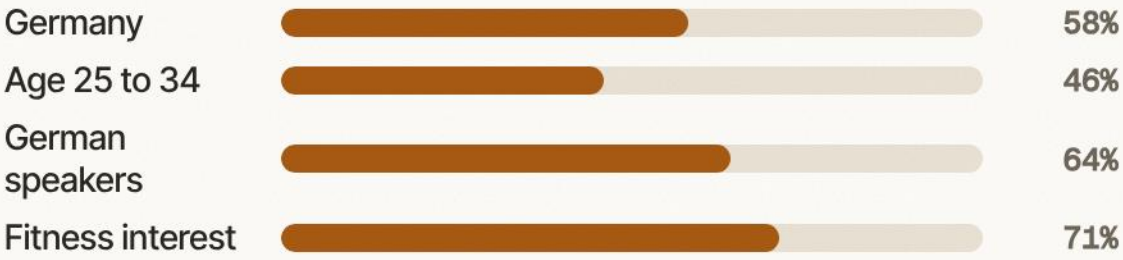
CHECK 01 · AUDIENCE · 30%

01

Who follows them, not *how many.*

Country, age, language and interests of their followers, held up against the brief.

EXAMPLE · THE AUDIENCE SCREENSHOT TO ASK FOR



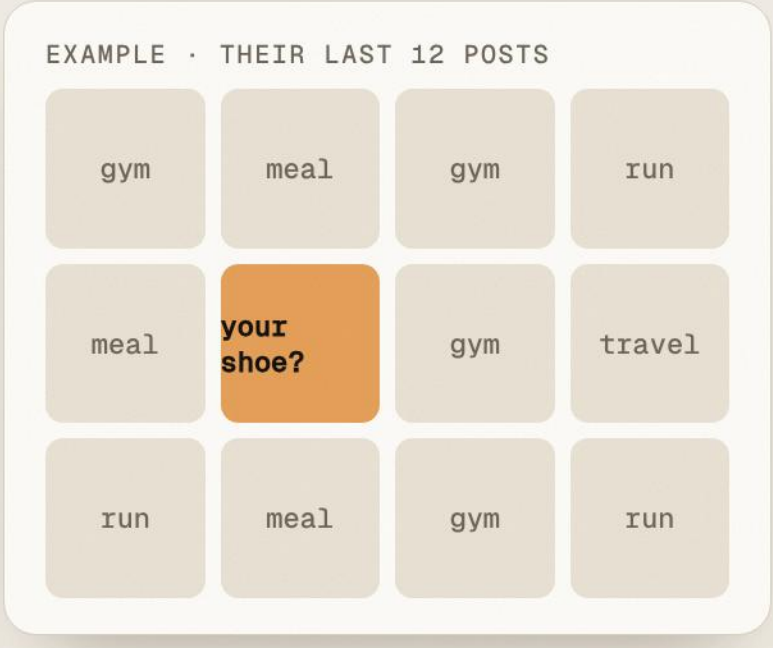
Ask the creator for their own Insights screenshots. Public tools only guess.

CHECK 02 · CONTENT · 25%

Would your product look *natural* here?

02

Open their last 12 posts. If your product would feel like an ad break, it will perform like one.



A running shoe fits this feed. A banking app doesn't.

CHECK 03 · ENGAGEMENT · 20%

Real comments, *steady* numbers.

03

Read the comments. Look for a steady line of views, not sudden spikes nobody can explain.

EXAMPLE · HEALTHY



STEADY

EXAMPLE · ASK WHY



ONE SPIKE

"Great post 🔥" x 40 from empty accounts is not engagement.

CHECK 04 · COST · 15%

The rate, against the *reach.*

04

Turn every quote into the cost of reaching 1,000 people. Then compare creators on the same scale.

example · cost per 1,000 reached

```
rate ÷ reach × 1,000 = CPM

€600 ÷ 20,000 × 1,000 = €30
€600 ÷ 60,000 × 1,000 = €10
```

Same price, three times the reach. Then check fit again: cheap reach in the wrong audience is still waste.

CHECK 05 · BRAND SAFETY · 10%

05

Would you be *proud* of the tag?

01 **Past controversies.** Search their name plus "drama" and read what comes up.

02 **Competitor deals.** A rival's ad last month makes your post look bought.

03 **Tone.** Their jokes, their comments, how they answer criticism.

DO IT WITH AI

The prompt I'd *use.*

paste into Claude or ChatGPT

```
Help me shortlist creators for this brief: [brief].
Score each creator 1-10 on audience fit (30%), content
fit (25%), engagement health (20%), cost (15%), brand
safety (10%).
Show a weighted total, one sentence of reasoning per
score, and a red-flag column.
Rank them, then tell me which 2 you'd drop first and why.
Creators: [name, platform, followers, avg views, rate,
notes]
```

What AI can't do: see private audience data or spot bought comments. You still check those.

SAVE THIS · THE 5 CHECKS

Fit beats *size.*

30%	**Audience fit** · country, age, language, interests
25%	**Content fit** · natural in their last 12 posts
20%	**Engagement health** · real comments, steady
15%	**Cost** · rate ÷ reach × 1,000
10%	**Brand safety** · past, rivals, tone

Creators: make your media kit answer these five, and you'll get the "yes" faster.



Want the full scoring *sheet?*

COMMENT

CHECK

and I'll DM you the free guide:

- ✓ the 5-check rubric with weights
- ✓ the prompt, copy and paste
- ✓ how to build the scoring sheet in Google Sheets

Follow for Week 3: I pitch brands for remote work myself.